

M MambaHR

THE ULTIMATE

RIF Playbook

How to run layoffs the right way — legally,
humanely, and efficiently.

Powered by MambaHR



Why this **playbook** exists

Let's be real — **layoffs are brutal**. No one wants to do them, and when they're done wrong the damage isn't just legal — it's personal. Yet most teams still run RIFs on spreadsheets that go out of sync, manager inputs buried in Slack, last-minute legal redlines, and no audit trail for why decisions were made.

Here's what you'll take away

- A compliance-first process that removes guesswork
- Structured rationale + scoring frameworks to reduce bias
- Templates for role selection, manager messaging, and documentation
- Legal-ready agreement language and post-RIF checklists



**Built by HR and
legal leaders — so
you only need to
run this process
once.**

Our proven RIF workflow

Seven steps, one system of record — start to finish.

01 Define scope

02 Legal sync

03 Manager input

04 Selection

05 Agreements

06 Comms

07 Offboarding



**This entire
workflow runs
inside MambaHR.**



What you're legally required to do

The federal floor for any reduction in force.

☒ WARN Act

☒ OWBPA (age 40+)

☒ ADEA

☒ Final pay

☒ COBRA

☒ Return of property



MambaHR
includes these
clauses in **every**
agreement.



Rationale types **you can use**

Document the business rationale for each impacted role — clearly and consistently.

Rationale	Example
Skill mismatch	Role now requires SaaS analytics expertise
Span / layer	Middle layer removed to flatten the org
Redundancy	Overlap after a recent acquisition
Performance	Documented underperformance over 2 quarters
Salary	20%+ above peer group
Tenure	Least tenured in a comparable function
Location	In-office requirement, role is remote-only
Business shift	Work is now outsourced

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MambaHR is built
with frameworks
aligned to **legal**
best practices.



Score selection **without bias**

Managers rate each role on the same scale — MambaHR averages the score.

KPI rating (1–5)	Soft skills (1–5)	Selection score (avg)



Managers input
rationale &
ratings —
MambaHR **guides**
selection with
ease.

Identify compensation risk

Review pay across similar roles to surface high-cost outliers.

Role	Name	Salary	Top 10% (Y/N)



Compare salaries to spot outliers across roles — instantly, **with MambaHR.**



Model every decision's impact

See the downstream effect before you commit.



Payroll reduction



WARN triggers



Impact analysis



OWBPA tracking



Real-time
dashboards
power confident,
data-backed
decisions.

Key clauses in a compliant severance agreement

Every defensible agreement carries these.

Severance

Expenses

Confidentiality

Return of property

COBRA

OWBPA



MambaHR
agreements
include every
clause shown
here, **by default.**



Messaging templates for every conversation

What to say — and what to avoid — at each step.

	Do	Don't
Audience		
Goal		
Examples		



Pre-written
templates guide
every RIF
conversation.



Final steps for a **compliant** RIF

The items HR must confirm — MambaHR tracks them automatically.

✓ Final pay

✓ Signed
agreements

✓ COBRA

✓ OWBPA

✓ State-specific
requirements

✓ HRIS + payroll
updates

Our dashboard
tracks all of this
automatically.

From manual chaos to structured clarity

Before MambaHR

Chaos — emails, word of mouth, last-minute legal

- Manager inputs sent over Slack, often incomplete
- Spreadsheets passed between HR, Legal, and Finance
- Legal reviewing documents the night before
- No audit trail or consistency in rationale or pay
- HR left chasing answers and updates manually

After MambaHR

Structure — clear options, generated PDFs, tracking

- Managers select rationale and input ratings in one place
- Department sheets sync to a centralized dashboard
- Agreements + OWBPA disclosures generated automatically
- Salary, tenure, and impact tracked in real time
- Everything documented, stored, and audit-ready

M MambaHR

Ready to lead with **clarity and confidence?**

MambaHR runs a compliant, defensible, people-first layoff — without spreadsheets, scattered inputs, or last-minute legal panic. From structured manager rationale to OWBPA-ready severance agreements, it automates every step and shows the business impact in real time.

Teams using MambaHR have cut RIF prep time by up to **70%**, closed documentation gaps, and delivered a more thoughtful experience for everyone involved.

Get started at mambahr.com →



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